Typography study

Magazine, newsprint, comics, posters, and interface references.

HIGH-CONTRAST SERIF

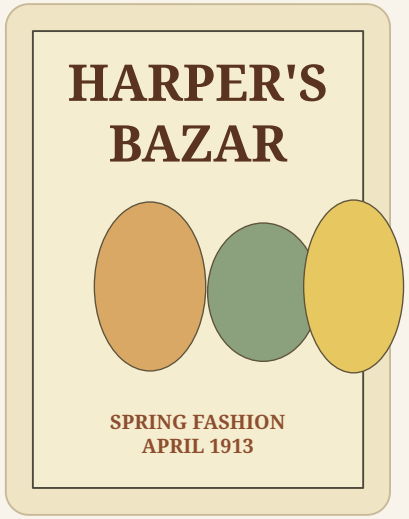
The thick-thin contrast feels editorial and a little dramatic. I would use it for the moments that should feel special, not for every label.

SMALL CAPS + TRACKING

Tiny uppercase labels work well for categories like DINNER, CONCERT, or CLASS. The extra spacing keeps them from feeling cramped.

READABLE UI SANS

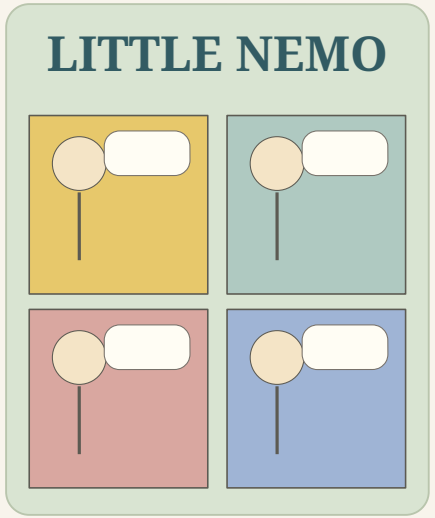
For controls and body text, I want something plain and open with a big x-height. It should stay easy to read on a phone.



Harper's Bazar, Apr. 1913, public domain



New-York Daily Times, first issue, public domain



Winsor McCay, Little Nemo, 1905, public domain

CONDENSED DISPLAY

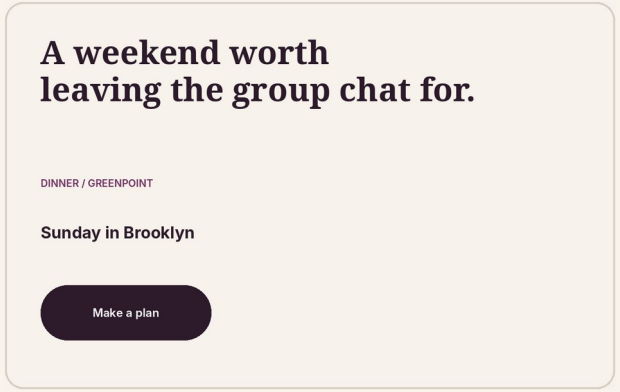
Condensed type gives a headline more energy without taking over the whole page. I would keep it big and use it rarely.

SERIF + SANS

The mix I keep coming back to is an expressive serif for headlines and a very plain sans for everything functional.



Joost Schmidt, Bauhaus exhibition poster, 1923



Interface layout sketch, made for this study

HIERARCHY FIRST

Big title, tiny category label, readable body copy, one obvious action. I want the order to be clear before you read a word.

TYPE PAIRINGS TO TRY

Fraunces + Inter
Cormorant Garamond + Manrope

Sources: public-domain archive references for Harper's Bazar (1913), New-York Daily Times (1851), Little Nemo (1905), and Bauhaus exhibition graphics.

What I am borrowing: contrast, hierarchy, and rhythm. Not the exact look of any one reference.

Color study

Photography, print, and material references. I want it warm, social, and a little unexpected.

WARM NEUTRAL BASE

I do not want a bright white app. Cream feels more like a menu, ticket, or magazine page, and it gives photos more room.

DEEP PLUM INSTEAD OF BLACK

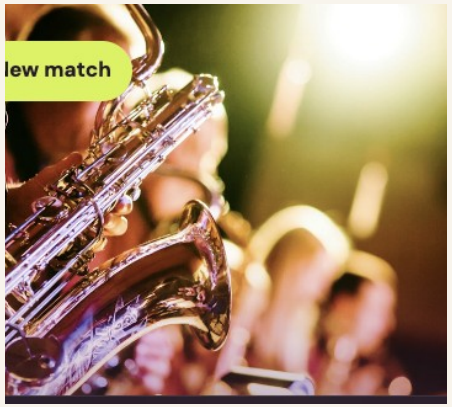
Almost-black plum still has enough weight for nav and display type, but it feels warmer and less severe than pure black.

DUSTY SUPPORT COLORS

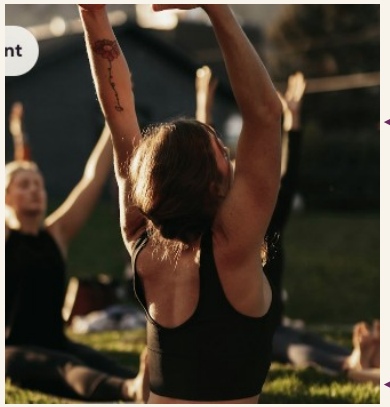
Blush, lilac, and sage can separate categories or people. Keep them muted so the brighter accent still wins.



Restaurant photo crop from my P1 visual study



Concert photo crop from my P1 visual study



Movement photo crop from my P1 visual study

CITRON = ACTION

This is the one color I want to feel loud. Small doses only: a match, a primary action, or something genuinely new.

SAGE = SETTLED

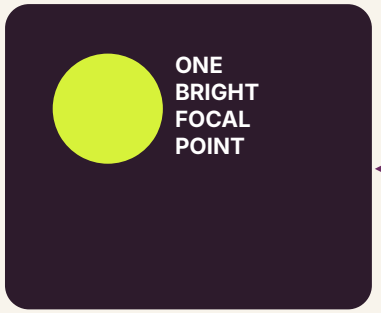
Sage works for accepted or settled states. It feels positive without turning every success state neon green.



WPA theatre poster reference, public domain



Color extraction from print and material references



Contrast study

NO RAINBOW UI

If a color is strong, it should mean something. Most of the screen can stay quiet so the important color actually matters.

PALETTE TO TRY

warm ivory	deep plum	citron	sage	coral	soft lilac
#F5F0E6	#392137	#D7F23A	#93A178	#D16B47	#D9CDE8

Print reference: public-domain WPA theatre poster from Wikimedia Commons. Photo crops are from my earlier P1 visual study.

These are working colors, not final. I still need to check text contrast before using them in the app.